

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1474

By Reeves

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the 21st District Recovery Court on the occasion of its twenty-fifth anniversary.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in honoring those programs and institutions that work to improve the lives of citizens and strengthen communities across this State; and

WHEREAS, one such exemplary program is the 21st District Recovery Court, which is celebrating its twenty-fifth anniversary, having been established in 2001 to address the critical intersection of addiction and the criminal justice system; and

WHEREAS, the mission of the 21st District Recovery Court is to end the cycle of addiction and crime in the community by providing accountability and compassion to nonviolent offenders, thereby saving lives, restoring families, and promoting safer and more productive communities; and

WHEREAS, the program was founded through the leadership and vision of the Honorable Timothy L. Easter, the Honorable Donald P. Harris, and coordinator Gayle Moyer Harris, whose dedication laid the groundwork for a model of justice rooted in both responsibility and rehabilitation; and

WHEREAS, following its establishment, the organization received nonprofit status in April 2002, and in August of that year, the first participants were admitted into its comprehensive two-year program; and

WHEREAS, since its inception, more than 300 individuals have participated in the Recovery Court program, with more than 200 successfully graduating; and

WHEREAS, the effectiveness of the 21st District Recovery Court is evidenced by its strong outcomes, including a proven record of reducing recidivism, saving taxpayer resources, and fostering long-term recovery among its participants; and

WHEREAS, in the past five years, approximately ninety percent of participants have maintained full- or part-time employment, while many have regained custody of their children and re-established relationships with their families; others have pursued educational advancement through earning a GED, high school diploma, or higher education opportunities; and

WHEREAS, most significantly, a substantial majority of graduates continue to lead stable, productive lives well beyond their time in the program, reflecting the enduring impact of the Recovery Court's work; and

WHEREAS, the success of the 21st District Recovery Court stands as a testament to the power of accountability, compassion, and community support in transforming lives and strengthening the fabric of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the 21st District Recovery Court on the occasion of its twenty-fifth anniversary, celebrating its many contributions to the well-being of individuals, families, and communities, and extend to all those associated with the program our best wishes for continued success in the years to come.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.